Administrator Account Management

Laboratory Report

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Student ID	c11/26/CCSA/17099
Course	CCSA102 Administrator Account Management
Assignment	Lab 2, Administrator Account Management
Completion date	3 November 2026
Virtualisation platform	VMware Workstation Pro 26.0.1.25688693 (26H1u1)
Management platform	A-SMS and SmartConsole R82

1. Introduction and Objectives

SmartConsole administrators work in sessions, which are working environments in which configuration changes are made without immediately affecting the live environment. Changes remain in the session until they are published or discarded. Because every administrator action is made through an account, the design of those accounts, their name, authentication method, permission profile and expiration, determines who can change the security environment and how far that access extends.

In this lab I applied those concepts on the Alpha Site Security Management Server (A-SMS). I modified the default cpadmin account, created a personal Super User account, an Auditor account, a custom IPS Only permission profile and an IPS administrator account, published the changes, and installed the database.

1.1 Objectives

My objectives were to:

- Modify the default cpadmin account (colour, comment and expiration).
- Create a personal Super User account using Check Point Password authentication.
- Create an Auditor account with the Read Only All permission profile.
- Create the IPS Only custom permission profile and an administrator account that uses it.
- Publish the changes and install the database.
- Answer the four short-answer questions using the lecture material.

1.2 Sources and evidence

I followed the assignment brief for the tasks and questions, used my screenshots (Figures 1 to 15) as the record of the work I performed, and drew on the lecture slides (Administrator Account Management, CCSA102) for concepts and terminology. The three screenshots the brief requires are labelled Screenshot A, B and C. SmartConsole does not display passwords, so my password entries appear only as masked characters.

2. Laboratory Environment and Configuration

2.1 Topology and devices

The brief restricts the lab to the management network (A-MGMT-NET, 10.1.1.0/24). The gateways, A-DMZ, A-LDAP, A-Host and the Border-Router are not used.

Device	Role (per brief)	IP address	Use in this lab
A-GUI	Workstation from which SmartConsole is opened	10.1.1.201/24	SmartConsole workstation (per brief)
A-SMS	Security Management Server; administrators are created on it	10.1.1.101/24	Used for all tasks
A-SME	Secondary management server; database installation target in Task 5	10.1.1.130/24	Not used, unavailable; excluded on instructor's direction

2.2 Platform and initial state

I performed the lab on VMware Workstation Pro using Check Point SmartConsole R82. Figure 1 shows SmartConsole connected to 10.1.1.101 as cpadmin, with A-SMS selected in Gateways & Servers. Its summary pane reports version R82 on Gaia, licence status OK and alerts OK, and the status bar shows "No changes", so my session was clean before I began configuring.

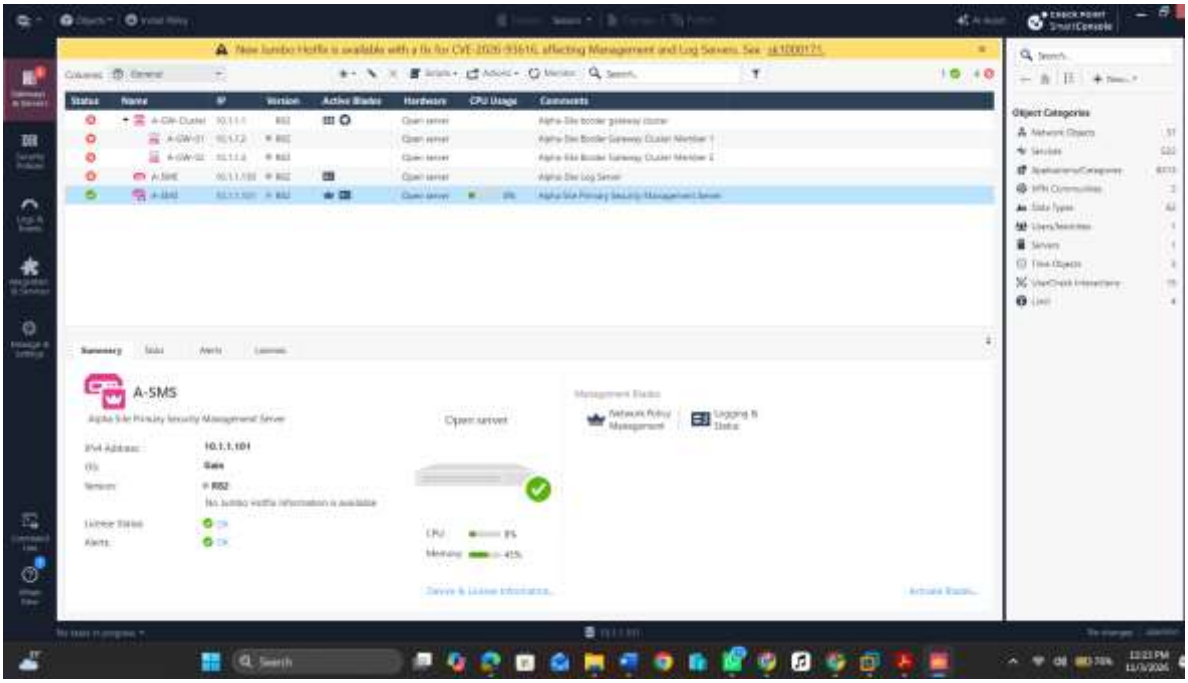


Figure 1: *SmartConsole R82 connected to A-SMS (10.1.1.101) as cpadmin (12:23 PM, 11/3/2026).*

What this proves: SmartConsole was connected to A-SMS as cpadmin on 3 November 2026 with no pending changes, and A-SME displays a red (not healthy) status.

2.3 A-SMS-only requirement

The brief's Task 5 installs the database on both A-SMS and A-SME. A-SME was unavailable, and our instructor directed students to use A-SMS only. I therefore did not configure A-SME and installed the

database on A-SMS alone, so I do not report the A-SME element of Task 5 or of Screenshot C. Figure 1 is consistent with this, as A-SME shows a red status icon.

3. Practical Implementation

I carried out all configuration under Manage & Settings > Permissions & Administrators in SmartConsole.

3.1 Task 1, Modify the default administrator (cpadmin)

Purpose. cpadmin is the default administrator created when the Security Management Server is deployed, and it holds Super User privileges. A colour and comment make it easy to identify in the Administrators list, and the expiration setting controls how long the account remains valid.

Procedure. I opened Administrators, double-clicked cpadmin, set Colour to Pink, Comment to "Default Check Point Administrator" and Expiration to Never, then clicked OK.

Outcome. Figure 2 shows the cpadmin properties with the pink icon, the comment "Default Check Point Administrator", Check Point Password authentication with a password defined, the Super User profile and Expiration set to Never. The Administrators list and details pane both show Never, and the account is recorded as modified by cpadmin on 11/3/2026 at 2:31 PM.

Setting	Required	Shown in the evidence
Colour	Pink	Pink icon
Comment	Default Check Point Administrator	Default Check Point Administrator
Expiration	Never	Never (dialog, list and details pane)

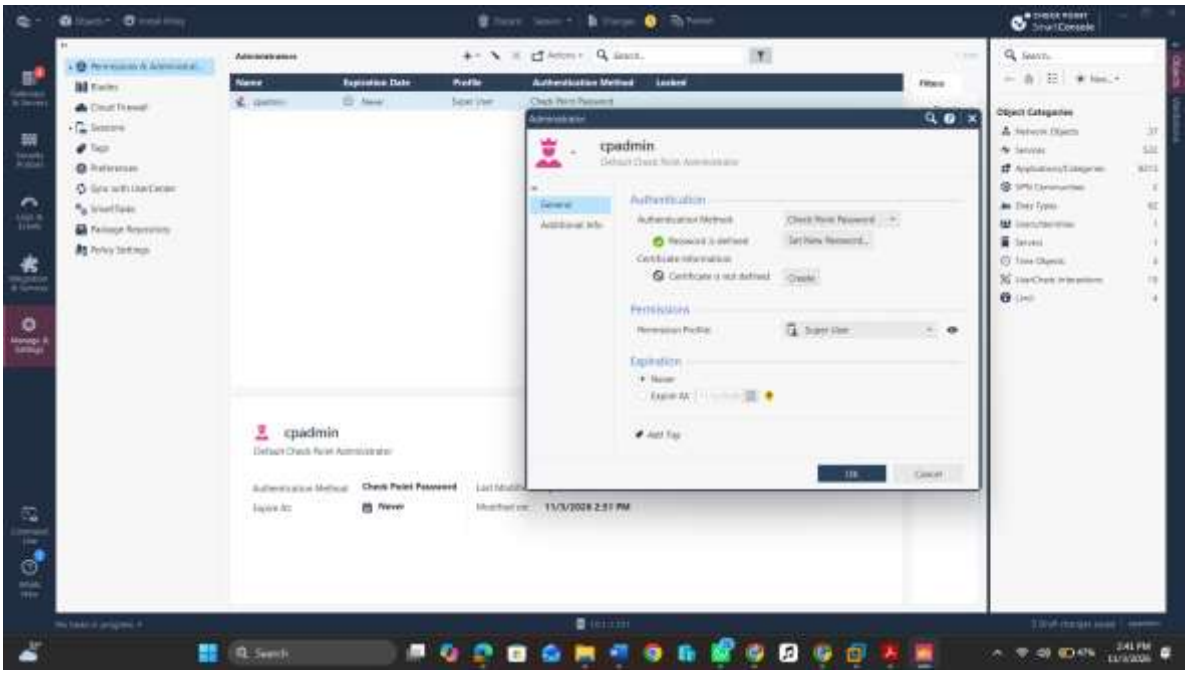


Figure 2: *cpadmin properties after modification, with the Administrators list behind (2:41 PM, 11/3/2026).*

What this proves: cpadmin carries a pink icon, the required comment and an expiration of Never.

3.2 Task 2, Create a personal Super User

Purpose. A personal account ties administrative actions to a named individual for auditing, since each administrator name must be unique. The Super User profile provides the full read and write permissions, including management of administrators and sessions, that the later tasks require.

Procedure. I created an administrator named gideon_akinsola (first and last name joined by an underscore, in lowercase) with Colour Pink, Comment “Me as a Super User”, Check Point Password authentication, a password set with “User must change password on next login” ticked, and the Super User profile.

Outcome. Figure 3 shows the New Administrator dialog for gideon_akinsola with the comment “Me as a Super User”, a pink icon, Check Point Password authentication, the Super User profile and Expiration Never. The Set Password dialog shows a masked password and confirmation with “User must change password on next login” ticked. Figure 4 shows the account in the Administrators list with Super User and Check Point Password.

Setting	Required	Shown in the evidence
Name	first_last in lower case	gideon_akinsola
Colour / comment	Pink / Me as a Super User	Pink icon / Me as a Super User

Setting	Required	Shown in the evidence
Authentication	Check Point Password	Check Point Password; password defined (masked)
Change at next login	Ticked	Ticked
Permission profile	Super User	Super User

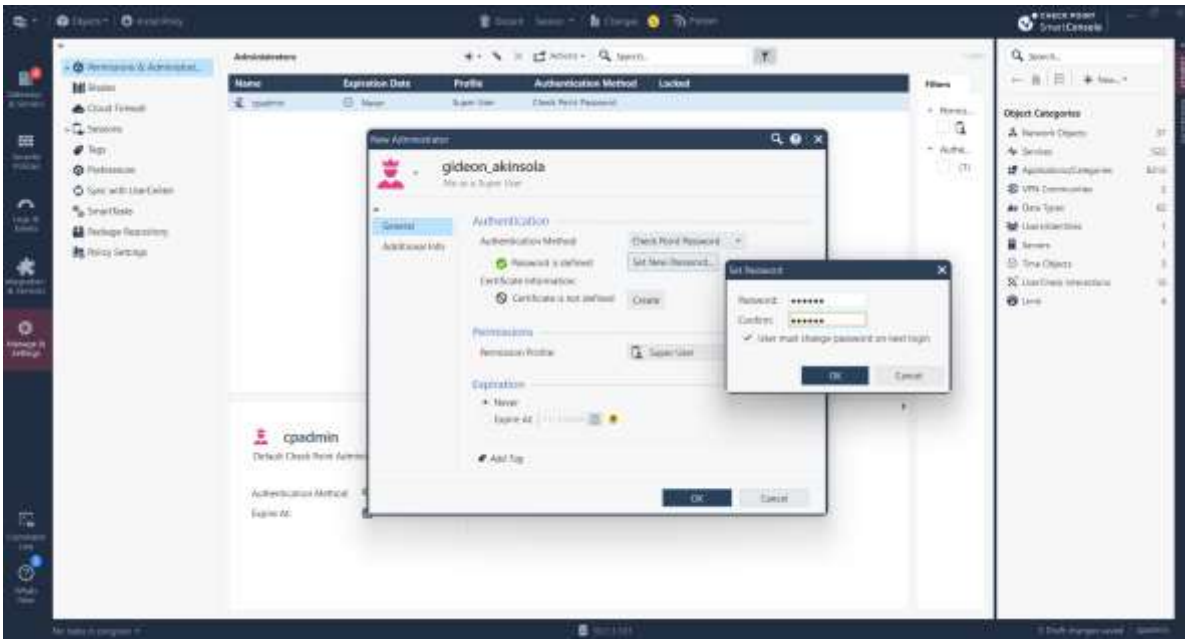


Figure 3: *New Administrator dialog for gideon_akinsola with the Set Password dialog open.*

What this proves: The personal account was configured with the required name, comment, authentication method, profile and change-at-next-login option.

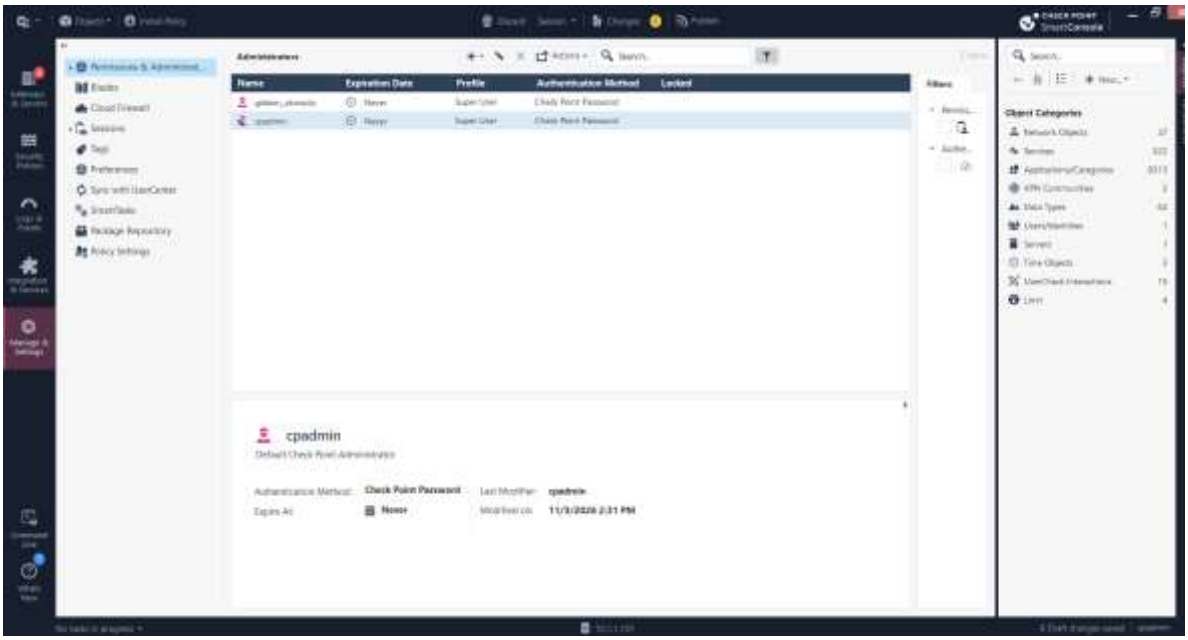


Figure 4: *Administrators list showing gideon_akinsola with the Super User profile; six draft changes saved.*

What this proves: The new personal administrator appears in the Administrators list with the Super User profile.

3.3 Task 3, Create an Auditor account

Purpose. An auditor needs to inspect the configuration without being able to alter it. Read Only All provides full read permissions and no write permissions, which suits an audit role under the principle of least privilege.

Procedure. I created an administrator named Auditor with Colour Crete Blue, Comment "Audit-only user", Check Point Password authentication and the Read Only All profile.

Outcome. Figure 5 shows the Auditor dialog with a blue icon, the comment "Audit-only user", Check Point Password authentication, the Read Only All profile and Expiration Never. I entered a masked password and also ticked "User must change password on next login", although the brief requires that option only for my personal account. Figure 6 shows Auditor in the list with Read Only All.

Setting	Required	Shown in the evidence
Name / comment	Auditor / Audit-only user	Auditor / Audit-only user
Colour	Crete Blue	Blue icon (colour name not displayed)
Authentication	Check Point Password	Check Point Password (masked password entered)
Permission profile	Read Only All	Read Only All

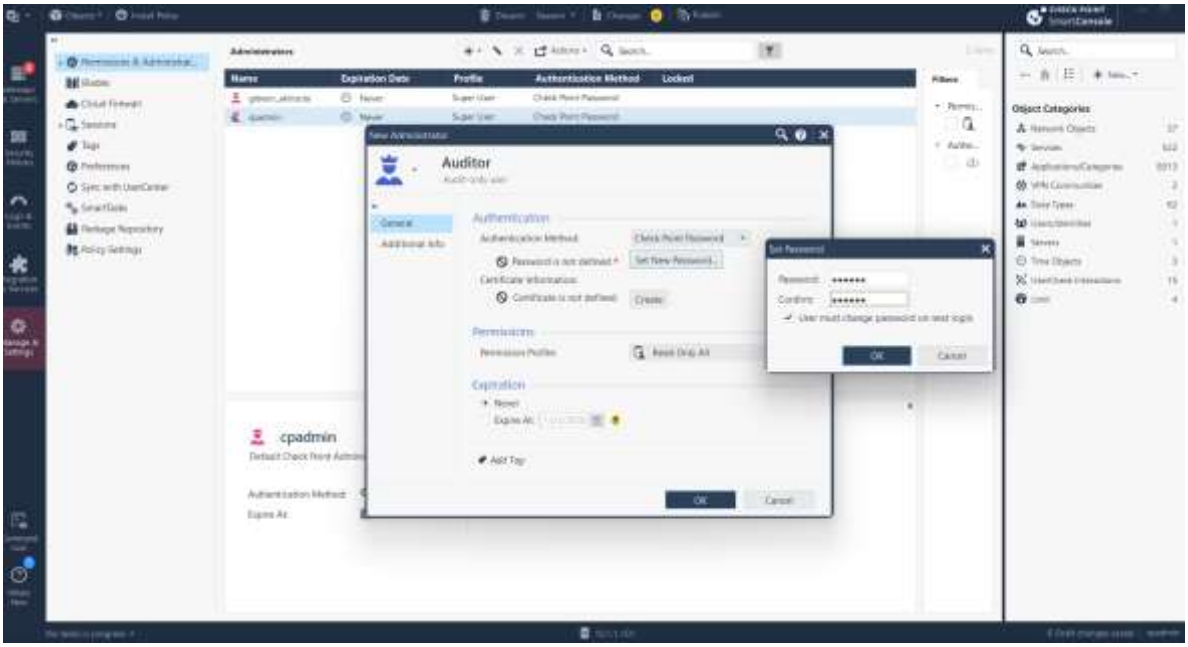


Figure 5: *New Administrator dialog for Auditor with the Set Password dialog open.*

What this proves: The Auditor account was configured with the Read Only All profile, Check Point Password authentication and the required comment.

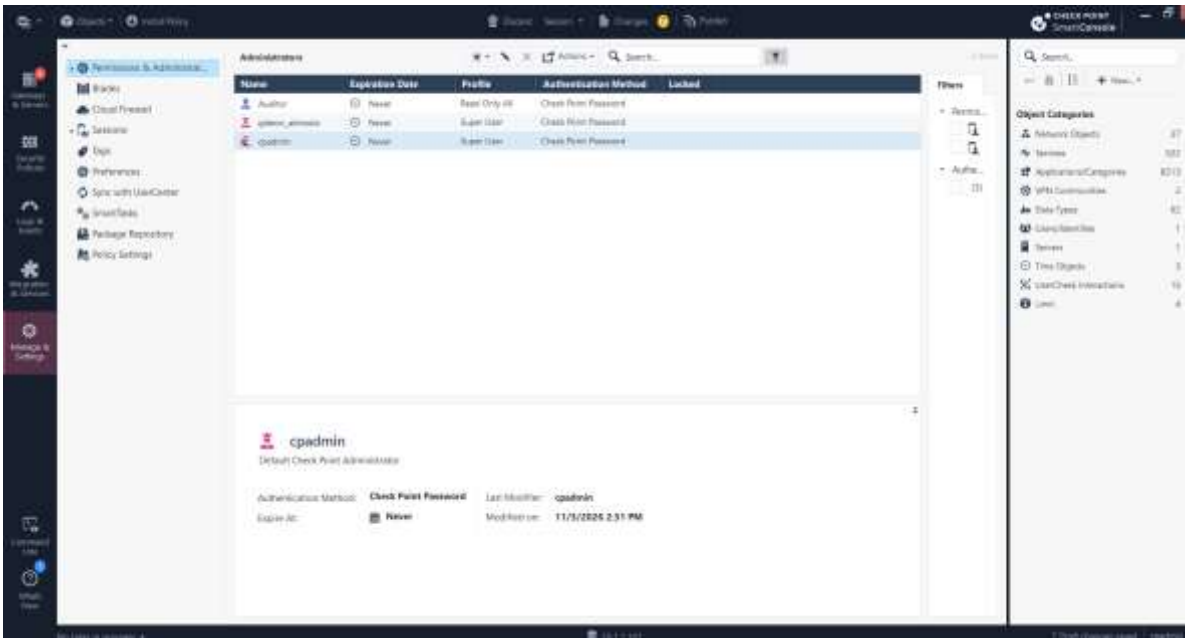


Figure 6: *Administrators list showing Auditor with Read Only All; seven draft changes saved.*

What this proves: Auditor appears in the Administrators list with the Read Only All profile.

3.4 Task 4, Custom permission profile and IPS administrator

Part A, IPS Only permission profile

Purpose. The predefined profiles cover broad roles, so a task-specific role needs a custom profile. A Customized profile lets individual permission areas be enabled or disabled, supporting least privilege for an administrator who should manage only IPS-related functions.

Procedure. Under Permission Profiles, I created a profile named IPS Only with Colour Violet Red, selected Customized, and disabled the main options under Management and Endpoint.

Outcome. Figure 7 shows the Permission Profiles list (4 items) with IPS Only beside Read Only All, Read Write All and Super User, and Figure 8 shows the profile set to Customized. In Figure 9, every Management option is unticked, with Manage Administrators and Manage Sessions shown greyed out. In Figure 10, every Endpoint option is unticked, with Authorize Pre-boot Users greyed out. The profile icon is violet-pink and the colour name is not displayed. I did not capture the other permission pages (Gateways, Access Control, Threat Prevention, Others, Monitoring and Logging, and Events and Reports), as the brief required changes only to Management and Endpoint.

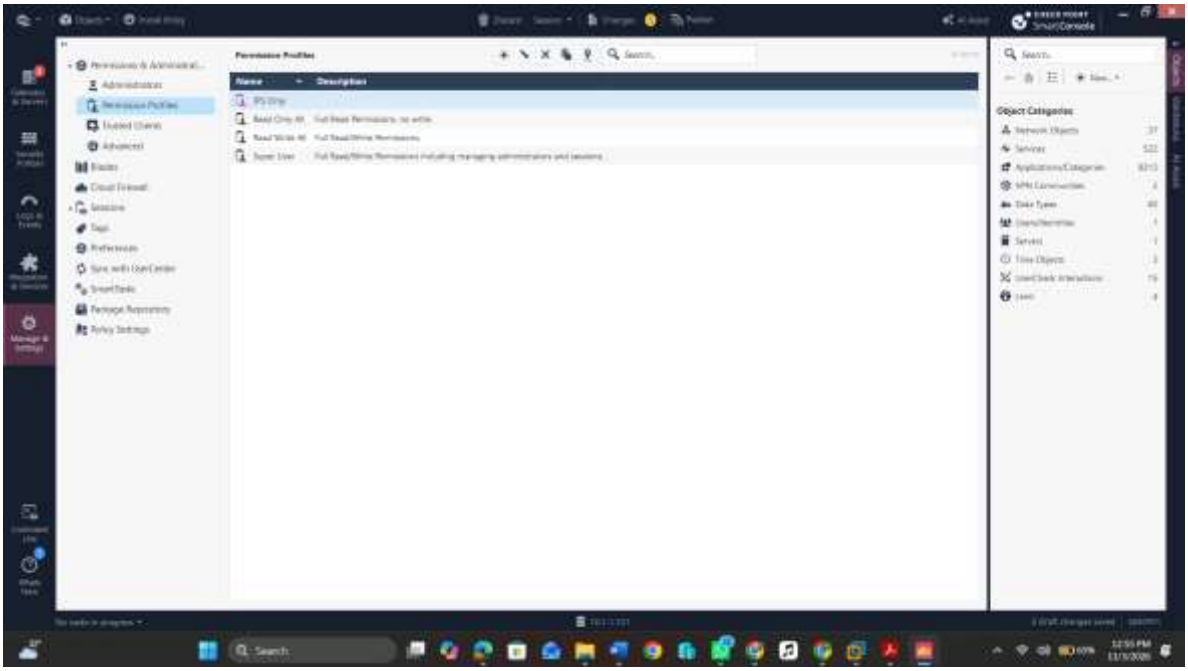


Figure 7 (Screenshot B): *Permission Profiles list containing the custom IPS Only profile (12:55 PM, 11/3/2026; first pass).*

What this proves: The custom IPS Only permission profile exists alongside the Read Only All, Read Write All and Super User default profiles.

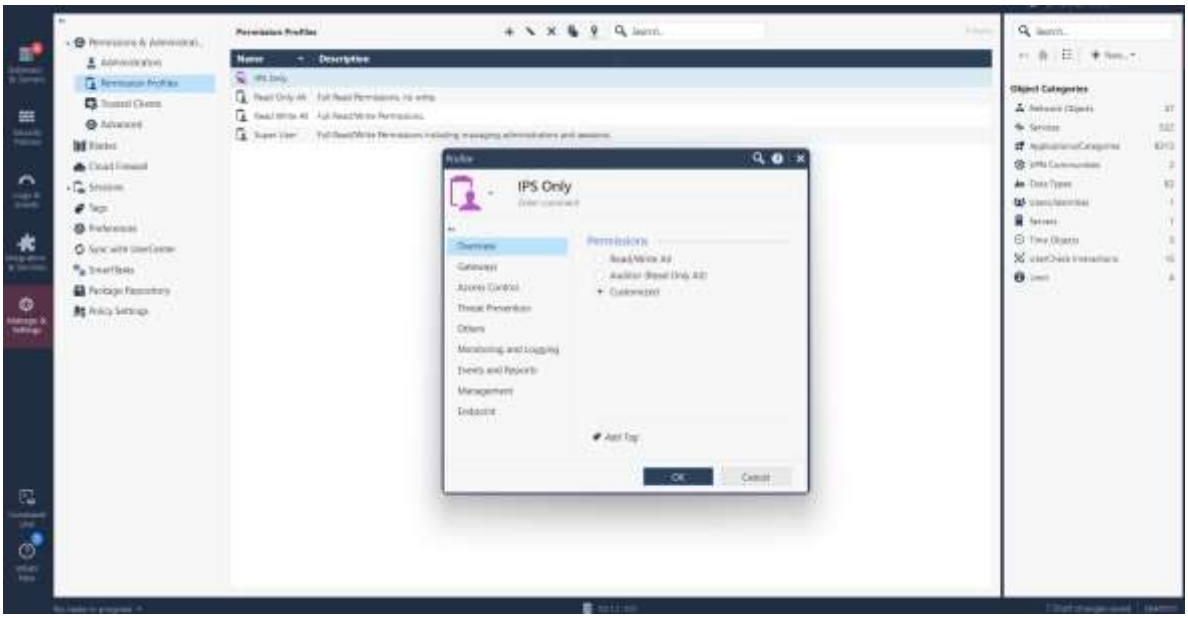


Figure 8: *IPS Only profile with the Customized permission option selected.*

What this proves: IPS Only is configured as a Customized profile rather than one of the predefined profiles.

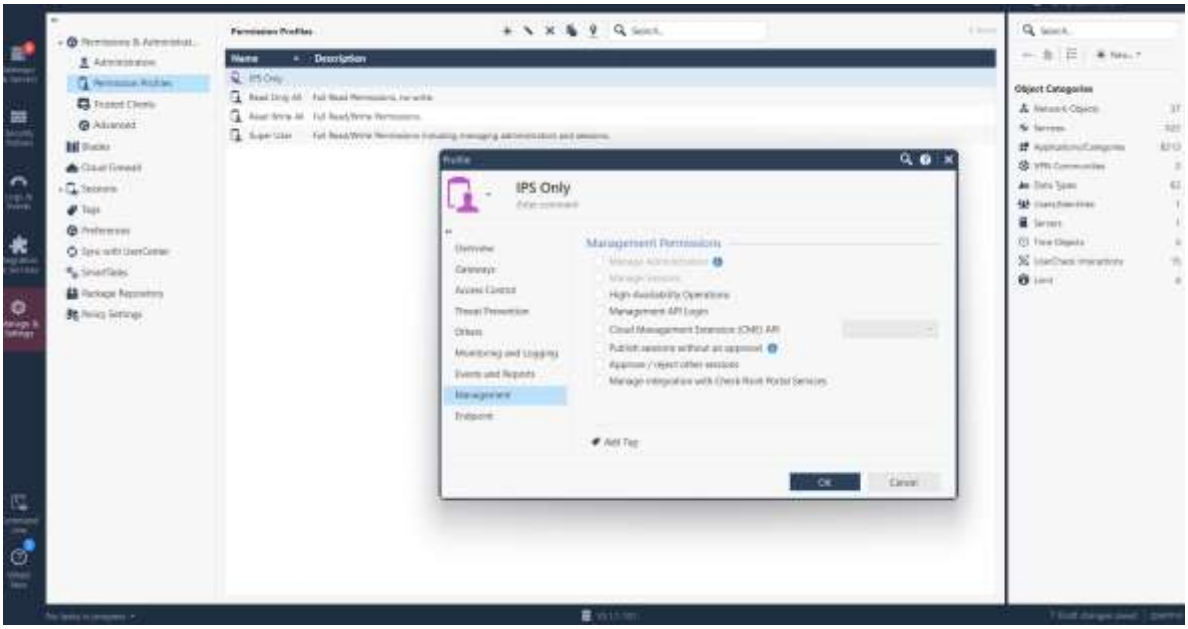


Figure 9: *IPS Only profile, Management page, with all options unticked.*

What this proves: The main Management permissions are disabled in the IPS Only profile.

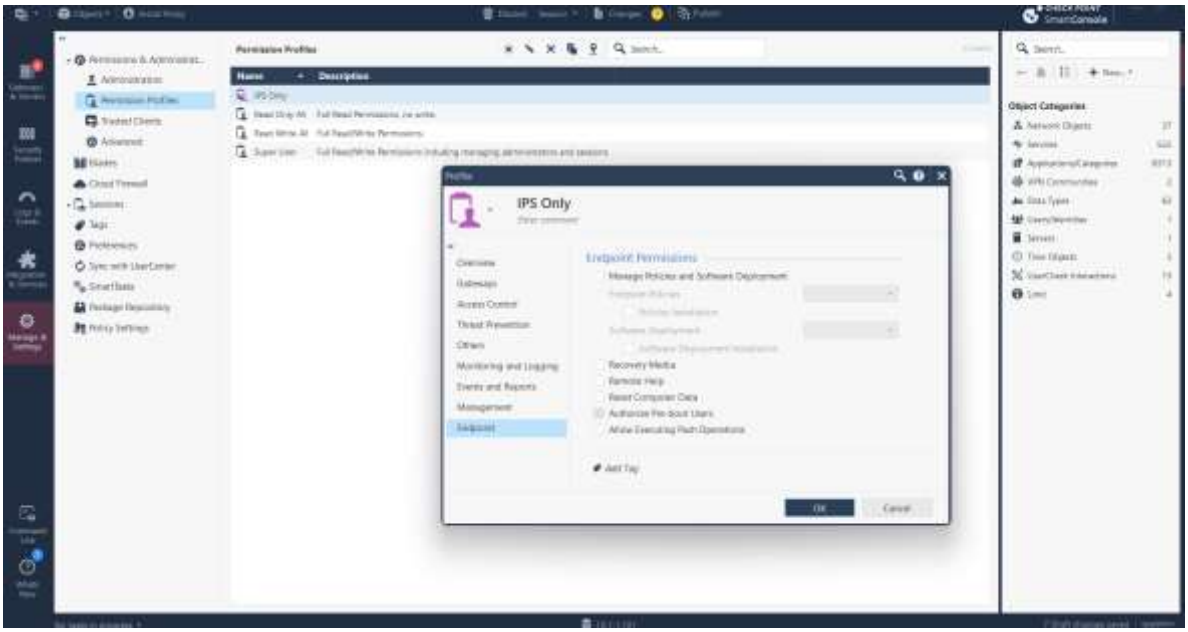


Figure 10: *IPS Only profile, Endpoint page, with all options unticked.*

What this proves: The main Endpoint permissions are disabled in the IPS Only profile.

Part B, IPS administrator account

Purpose. This account applies the new profile to a named administrator, showing how a custom profile delegates a narrow set of tasks.

Procedure. I created an administrator with Colour Crete Blue, Check Point Password authentication and the IPS Only permission profile. The brief names this account IPS Administrator.

Outcome. I created the account with the name **IPS Administrators**, as shown in Figures 11 and 12. Figure 11 shows a blue icon, Check Point Password authentication with a password defined, the IPS Only profile and Expiration Never, and the "User must change password on next login" option ticked in the Set Password dialog. Figure 12 shows all four required accounts: IPS Administrators (IPS Only), Auditor (Read Only All), gideon_akinsola (Super User) and cpadmin (Super User), all with Check Point Password authentication and expiration Never. Eight draft changes were pending and the Publish button was active at this point. This figure serves as Screenshot A.

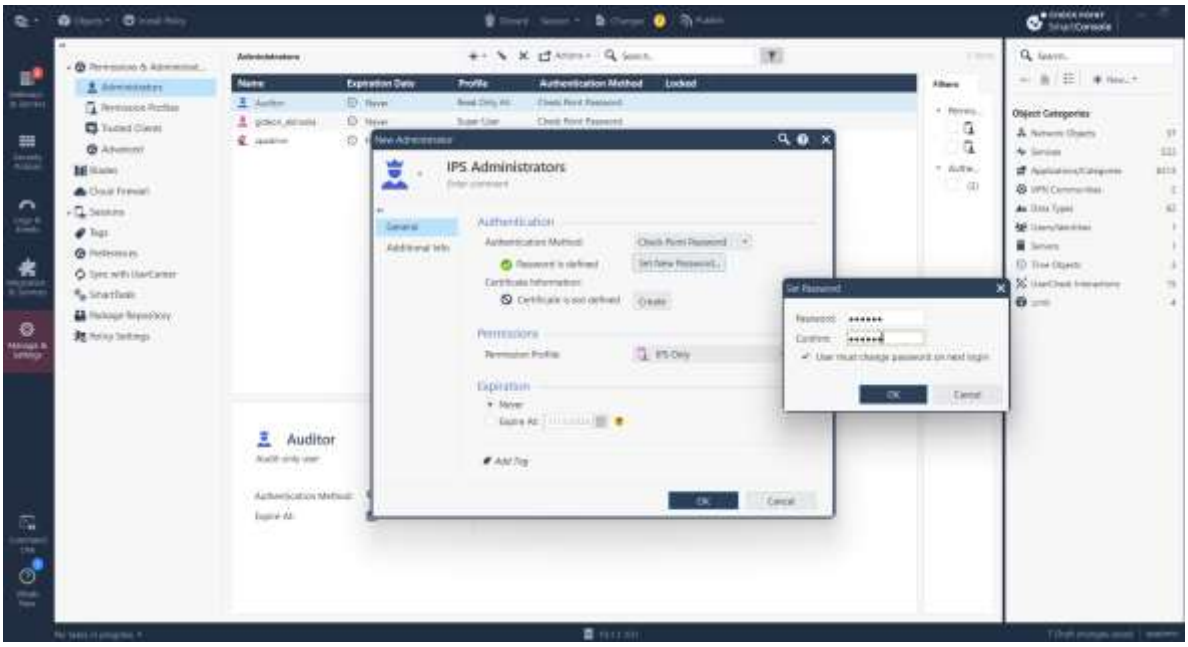


Figure 11: *New Administrator dialog for the IPS administrator with the IPS Only profile and the Set Password dialog open.*

What this proves: The IPS administrator account uses Check Point Password authentication and the custom IPS Only profile.

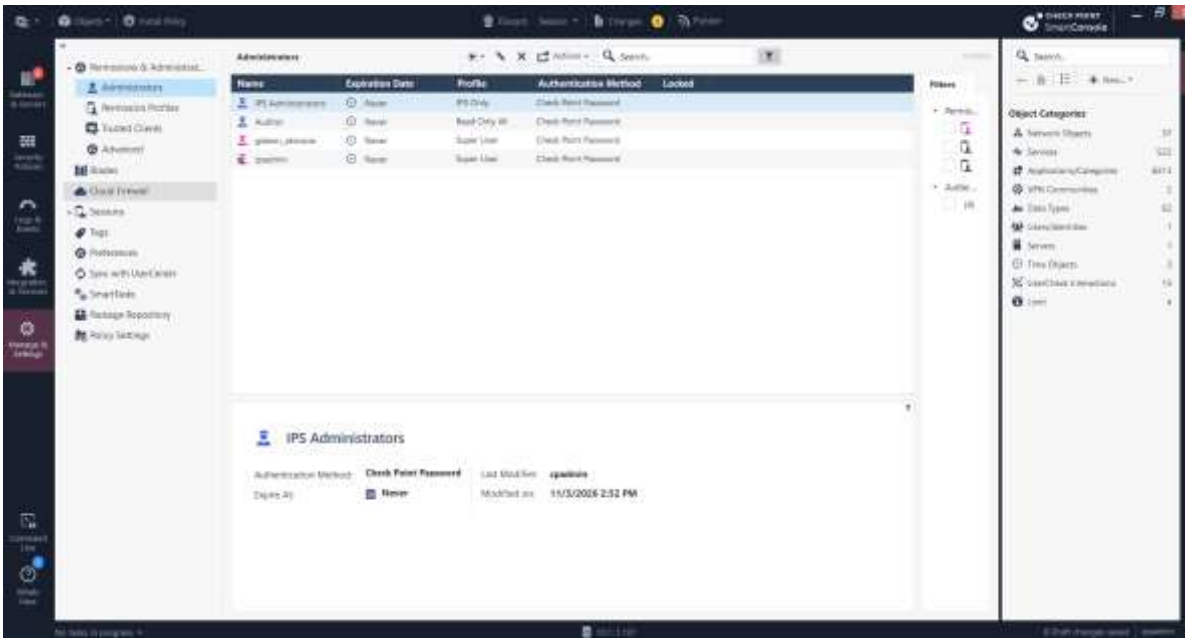


Figure 12 (Screenshot A): *Administrators list showing all four required accounts before publishing; eight draft changes saved.*

What this proves: All four required accounts exist, and the IPS administrator account carries the IPS Only profile.

3.5 Task 5, Publish and install the database

Publishing

Purpose. Session changes are saved automatically as drafts and remain until they are discarded or published. Publishing saves them to the management database, makes them visible to other administrators and creates a revision.

Procedure. I clicked Publish, entered the session name “Added New Administrators and Permissions Profile”, and confirmed.

Outcome. Figure 13 shows the Publish dialog with that session name entered and a total of 8 draft changes. Figure 14 shows the Revisions view after publishing, published by cpadmin with 8 changes. The audit log shows a Publish operation at 2:54:43 PM, and the Discard, Changes and Publish controls are greyed out with the status bar reading “No changes”. The Name column is truncated in this view, so the full session name is shown only in Figure 13.

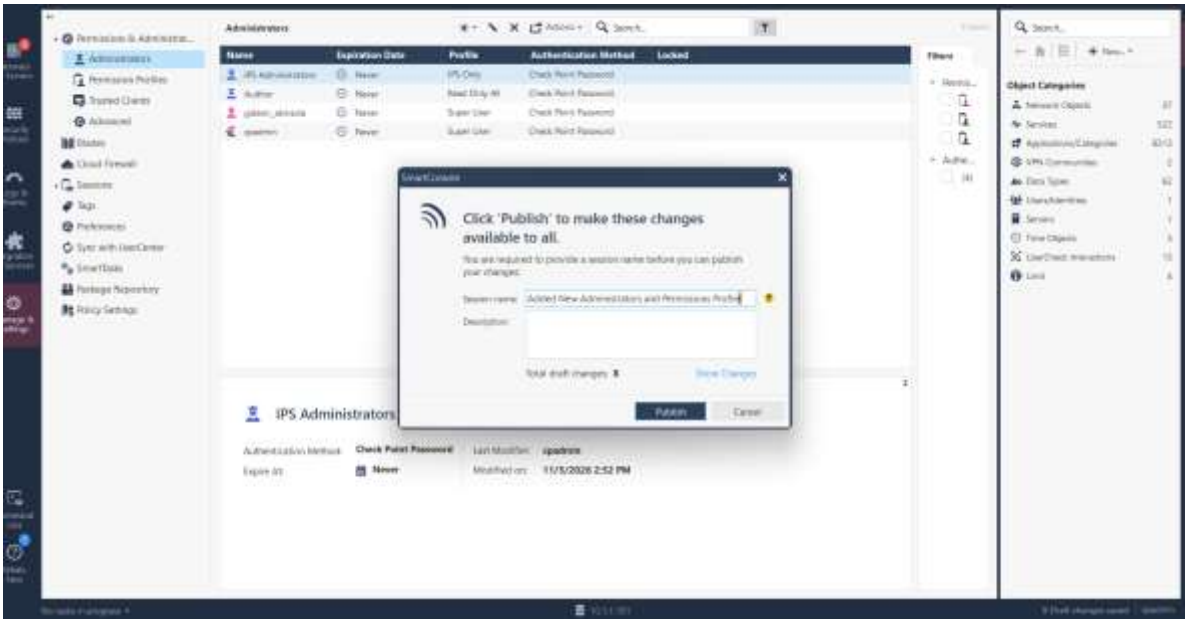


Figure 13: *Publish dialog with the required session name entered; eight draft changes.*

What this proves: The changes were published under the session name Added New Administrators and Permissions Profile.

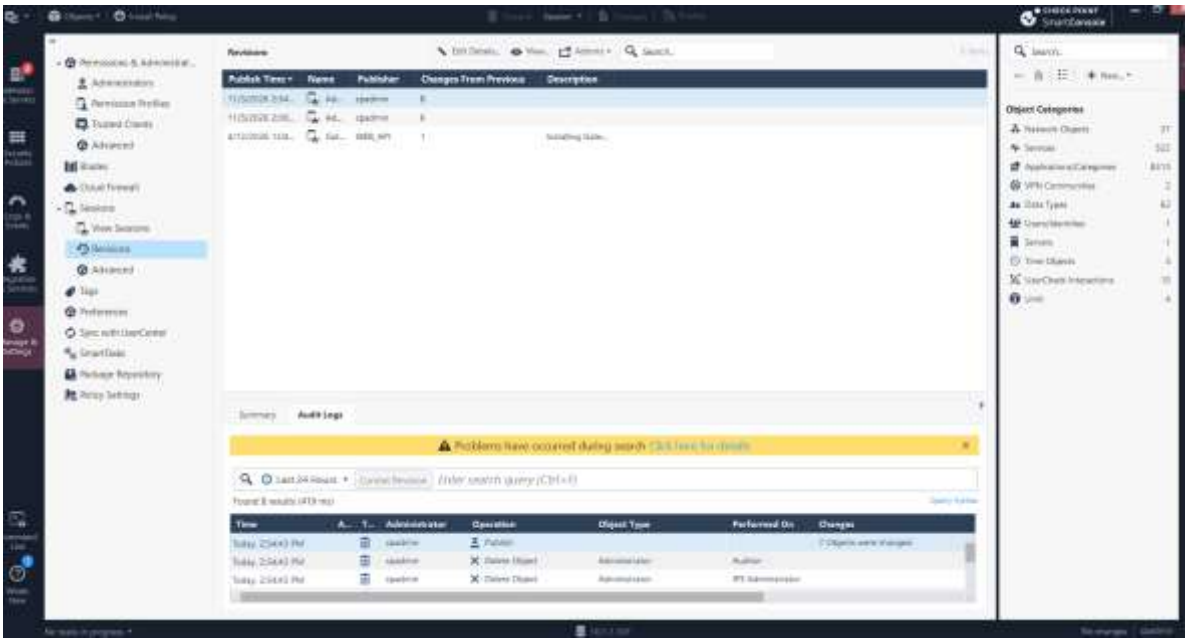


Figure 14: *audit log after publishing (2:54 PM, 11/3/2026).*

What this proves: The changes were published by cpadmin, with no pending changes remaining.

Database installation (A-SMS only)

Purpose. Install Database distributes the published management database to the selected management servers so that they hold the new administrator definitions.

Procedure. The brief selects both A-SMS and A-SME. Following the instructor's direction, I installed the database on A-SMS only.

Outcome. Figure 15 shows the Recent Tasks panel with "Install Database on A-SMS, Database installation succeeded for: A-SMS" at 03-Nov-26 14:56:11 by cpadmin, and the status bar reads "Install Database on A-SMS Succeeded". The Administrators list behind it shows the four accounts, and the session has no pending changes. No task for A-SME is listed.

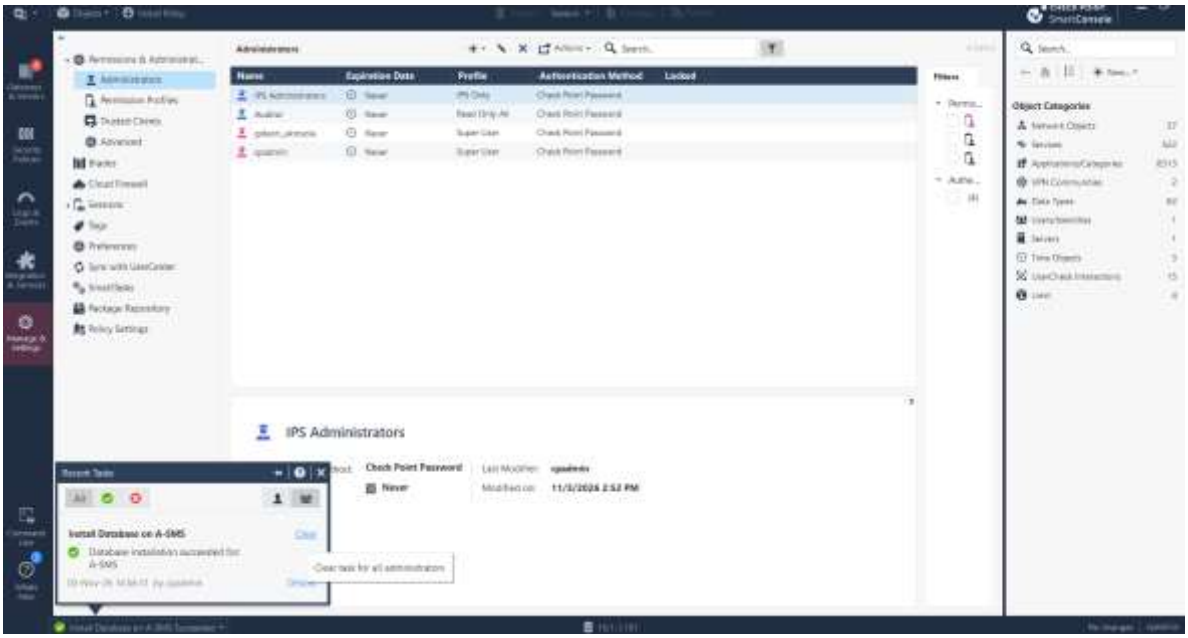


Figure 15 (Screenshot C, A-SMS only): *Recent Tasks showing Install Database on A-SMS succeeded (14:56:11, 03-Nov-26).*

What this proves: The Install Database task succeeded on A-SMS; A-SME was excluded as instructed.

4. Short-Answer Questions

Question 1

Explain the difference between a Check Point Password and an OS Password authentication method.

A Check Point Password is a static password that I define for the administrator on the Security Management Server, which makes it the simplest authentication method. An OS Password instead checks the administrator against the Gaia operating system password on the Security Management Server, so it is managed at the operating-system level rather than in the SmartConsole account. Both are local to the server, unlike external methods such as RADIUS, TACACS or SecurID.

Question 2

What is the main difference between the default Super User and Read Only All permission profiles?

The main difference is that Super User has full read and write permissions, including the ability to manage administrators and sessions, whereas Read Only All has full read permissions but no write permissions. An administrator with Read Only All can therefore view the configuration but cannot change anything.

Question 3

In session management, what happens to your changes if you click Discard versus if you click Publish?

My changes are saved automatically as drafts in the session until I act on them. If I click Discard, they are deleted and the database stays as it was. If I click Publish, they are saved to the database, become visible to other administrators and create a new revision.

Question 4

According to best practices, why should you limit the use of Super User accounts and apply the principle of least privilege?

Super User can change almost everything, including other administrators, so limiting it reduces the risk of accidental or malicious changes that could destabilise the system or weaken security. Least privilege gives each administrator only the permissions their role needs, which limits the damage a mistake or a compromised account can cause. Permissions should also be reviewed regularly so that they keep matching current job functions.

5. Conclusion

I completed the lab on A-SMS. I set cpadmin to Pink with the required comment and an expiration of Never, and created a personal Super User account, an Auditor account with Read Only All, the IPS Only Customized profile with its Management and Endpoint options disabled, and an IPS administrator account using that profile, all with Check Point Password authentication. I published the changes under the required session name and installed the database successfully on A-SMS. A-SME was excluded on the instructor's direction because it was unavailable.

Through this lab I learned that an administrator account is defined by its name, authentication method, permission profile and expiration, and that publishing is what commits session changes to the database. It also reinforced least privilege, since the Auditor and IPS accounts hold only the access their roles require.

6. References

- CCSA102 (2026) Administrator Account Management [lecture slides]. Check Point Certified Security Administrator course.
- CCSA102 Lab 2: Administrator Account Management (Student Copy), Check Point Certified Security Administrator (CCSA) R82. Instructor: Bello Ridwan Olayinka.
- Check Point Software Technologies. Quantum Security Management Administration Guide (R82), as referenced in the lecture slides.